Summary
Impact Measurement 2024

Methodology

Data collection between 2021 and 2024.

Data samples:
- Longitudinal quantitative survey (n=63)
- Cross-sectional mixed-method survey (n=41)

Measured indicator categories:
- Well-being
- Shocks and stressors
- Shock-responsive capacities

Analysis:
- Multivariate analysis of variance

Key Findings

Financial Capital
- Mixed effects on recipients' ability to save money and cover emergency expenses
- Statistically significant improvement in income diversification, with additional income sources increasing from 60% to 83%.
- Increased household debt, potentially indicating improved financial security.

Social Capital
- 85% of recipients reported improved ability to support their families and communities
- The majority of participants noted improvements in personal relationships; 13% also experienced some tensions during the same period.

Well-Being and Spending Priorities
- Education (42%) and food (37%) were the top spending categories.
- 83% of participants felt more financially secure, attributing improvements to consistent cash transfers.

Employment and Household Dynamics
- Increased self-employment, with 21% transitioning from unemployment.
- Disability-related employment barriers significantly reduced.
- Median household dependents rose from 4.5 to 6.5, highlighting increased family responsibilities.

Challenges and Insights

- **Limitations:** Small sample size, data gaps, and potential self-reporting biases limit generalizability.
- **Financial Security:** While cash transfers offered a buffer against shocks, high inflation in Sierra Leone reduced their value.
- **Program Design:** Targeting diversity and low transfer amounts may have led to mixed outcomes.

Takeaways

- Significant improvements in income diversification and shock-responsiveness.
- Consider increasing transfer values and remain attentive to emerging tensions.
- No evidence of harm.